

■ Step-by-Step Guide to Install and Run Django Server with Waitress on Windows (Using NSSM)

1. Install Required Software

- Install Python: Download from <https://www.python.org/downloads/>, check 'Add Python to PATH' during installation, verify with 'python --version'.
- Install NSSM: Download from <https://nssm.cc/download>, extract, copy nssm.exe to C:\Windows\System32, verify with 'nssm' command.

2. Get the Project Code from GitHub

- Go to your GitHub repo in browser.
- Click green 'Code' button → 'Download ZIP'.
- Extract the ZIP to a folder, e.g., C:\Users\YourName\DjangoProject.

3. Setup Virtual Environment

- Open Command Prompt in your project folder.
- Run 'pip install virtualenv'.
- Run 'python -m venv venv'.
- Activate with 'venv\Scripts\activate'.

4. Install Project Dependencies

- Inside virtual environment, run: 'pip install -r requirements.txt'.

5. Run Django Migrations

- Run 'python manage.py migrate'.
- Create superuser with 'python manage.py createsuperuser'.

6. Test Server with Waitress

- Run: waitress-serve --listen=0.0.0.0:8000 your_project_name.wsgi:application
- Open <http://localhost:8000> in browser.

7. Create Windows Service using NSSM

- Open Command Prompt as Administrator.
- Run 'nssm install DjangoServer'.
- Set Path: point to venv\Scripts\python.exe.
- Arguments: -m waitress --listen=0.0.0.0:8000 your_project_name.wsgi:application.
- Startup Directory: your Django project folder.
- Click Install Service.

8. Start the Service

- Run 'nssm start DjangoServer'.
- Access app at <http://localhost:8000>.

9. Managing the Service

- Stop: `nssm stop DjangoServer`.
- Remove: `nssm remove DjangoServer`.

■ You're Done!

- Your Django project now runs with Waitress on Windows as an NSSM service.
- The server auto-starts even after reboot.